NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

STARTUP TACTICS · SALES: EARLY CUSTOMER DEMAND GENERATION

# EARN THE FIRST YES.

**Team NBC (Next Billion Children)**

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Fall 2026 · Tactic week Wed 14 – Tue 20 Oct 2026 · Outreach designed; sending starts Wed 14 Oct

Full brand guide (PDF) · Outreach kit and lead-list template on GitHub

THE VENTURE

# ANSWERS ARE CHEAP. CAPABILITY ISN'T.

Algo Peers is building Next Billion Children (NBC): **learning infrastructure that makes physical learning and human capability legible.** NBC is Physical AI where children build, experiment and develop capabilities with shared AI, and where what they demonstrate becomes evidence. It starts from five years of Algo Peers practice in Cape Coast, Ghana.

**PHYSICAL LEARNING**

Learning Worlds built from programmable materials: build, predict, test, revise.

**EVIDENCE**

What a child demonstrated, under what conditions and with what help.

**SHARED AI**

One AI per learning centre supports the facilitator. No device per child.

THE BRIEF

# FIND THE BUYERS WHO WILL SAY YES.

## OPERATORS FEEL THE PAIN.

People who already run hands-on programmes answer when we name their problem: great sessions are hard to repeat.

## SCHOOLS WANT PROOF, NOT PITCHES.

Heads and STEM coordinators reply to a free pilot seat and a short evidence summary.

## SPONSORS FUND A CREDIBLE PILOT.

CSR and foundation teams reply to access for children who can’t pay, with clear reporting.

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**The experiment:** three profiles, 50+ leads each, three messages and a four-touch sequence. We count replies and pilot calls booked, not opens.

DESIGNED · SENDING FROM WED 14 OCT

01

# THE PLAN

What we want from outbound, what we believe, and how we will know.

EXPERIMENT OUTLINE · PART 1

# WHAT WE WANT FROM THIS TACTIC.

## TEN CONVERSATIONS

Ten first calls with people who could buy, host or fund an NBC pilot.

## THREE PILOT OFFERS

Three program owners willing to discuss a paid pilot with a stated price.

## A REPEATABLE MOTION

A lead list, messages and sequence any teammate can run in a new city or country.

EXPERIMENT OUTLINE · PART 2

# WHAT WE BELIEVE.

| | |
|---|---|
| **H1 · PROGRAM OWNERS** | Operators of hands-on programmes reply at 15% or more when the message names their real problem: repeating a great session without a star facilitator. |
| **H2 · SCHOOL LEADERS** | Heads and STEM coordinators at private and mission schools reply at 10% or more to a pilot seat plus an evidence summary. |
| **H3 · SPONSORS** | CSR and foundation officers reply at 8% or more to a sponsored-access pilot with clear reporting. |

Reply-rate targets are our own pass lines, set before sending. A reply is a human answer, positive or negative.

EXPERIMENT OUTLINE · PART 3

# THE EXPERIMENT.

## BUILD

50+ leads per profile from public directories and networks, every row sourced.

## WRITE

One core message per profile, plus three follow-ups.

## SEND

25+ first messages in week one; the rest in week two, from our own accounts.

## TRACK

Every touch logged in our CRM: sent, replied, call booked, pilot offer.

## LEARN

Revise the weakest message after 25 sends; compare reply rates by profile.

**Rules we keep:** adults only, reached in their professional role. No children are contacted or targeted. We message one person at a time, honour every opt-out at once, and never buy contact lists.

02

# THE TARGETS

Where the buyers gather, and the three kinds of people we will write to.

TARGETS · ORGANISATIONS (B2B)

COLLECTED DURING TACTIC WEEK · REAL DATA ONLY

# WHERE THE BUYERS GATHER.

## PROGRAM OWNERS

Code Club and micro:bit community maps

Africa Code Week and similar partner lists

Makerspace and STEM-club directories

LinkedIn: "STEM program director", "after-school founder"

## SCHOOLS

National private-school council member lists

Mission and faith school networks

Education-service district school lists (public)

LinkedIn: "head of school", "ICT coordinator"

## SPONSORS

CSR pages and annual reports of listed companies

Foundation and grant directories

Development-partner education programmes

LinkedIn: "CSR manager", "program officer, education"

Global by design: the same sources exist in most countries. We start with Cape Coast and one contrasting city. Screenshots of each source are added as the lists are built.

# THE PROGRAM OWNER.

| | |
|---|---|
| TITLES | Founder, director or coordinator of an after-school, holiday, club or STEM program |
| ORGANISATION | 1–20 staff; runs recurring sessions for ages about 9–12 |
| MINDSET | Loves hands-on learning; worn out by re-planning every session; needs proof for parents |
| PAIN WE NAME | Great sessions depend on one star facilitator |
| BUYS | A program or site fee; parents may fund it through fees |

TARGETS · PROFILE 2 OF 3

# THE SCHOOL LEADER.

| | |
|---|---|
| TITLES | Head teacher, deputy head, ICT or STEM coordinator |
| ORGANISATION | Private, mission or international school |
| MINDSET | Must teach computing with few working devices; wants parents to see progress |
| PAIN WE NAME | Equipment sits unused; no record of what pupils can do |
| BUYS | A per-classroom licence, billed per term |

TARGETS · PROFILE 3 OF 3

# THE SPONSOR.

| | |
|---|---|
| TITLES | CSR manager, foundation program officer, partnerships lead |
| ORGANISATION | Company, foundation or development partner with an education focus |
| MINDSET | Wants measurable, reportable impact, not one-off donations |
| PAIN WE NAME | Hard to show what children gained |
| BUYS | Sponsored access for public schools, with reporting |

03

# THE LISTS

Fifty real people per profile. Every row sourced. No bought lists.

LEAD LIST · PROFILE 1

0 OF 50 · LIST BEING BUILT

# THE PROGRAM OWNERS: 50+ LEADS.

| # | NAME | TITLE | ORGANISATION | TYPE | CITY, COUNTRY | EMAIL | LINKEDIN | SOURCE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | | | | | |
| 8 | | | | | | | | | |

Template shown with empty rows. Real leads, with every attribute and contact, go into the CRM and the lead-list template. Contact details stay in the private workspace, not on public slides.

LEAD LIST · PROFILE 2

0 OF 50 · LIST BEING BUILT

# THE SCHOOL LEADERS: 50+ LEADS.

| # | NAME | TITLE | ORGANISATION | TYPE | CITY, COUNTRY | EMAIL | LINKEDIN | SOURCE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | | | | | |
| 8 | | | | | | | | | |

Template shown with empty rows. Real leads, with every attribute and contact, go into the CRM and the lead-list template. Contact details stay in the private workspace, not on public slides.

LEAD LIST · PROFILE 3

0 OF 50 · LIST BEING BUILT

# THE SPONSORS: 50+ LEADS.

| # | NAME | TITLE | ORGANISATION | TYPE | CITY, COUNTRY | EMAIL | LINKEDIN | SOURCE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | | | | | |
| 8 | | | | | | | | | |

Template shown with empty rows. Real leads, with every attribute and contact, go into the CRM and the lead-list template. Contact details stay in the private workspace, not on public slides.

04

# THE WORDS

Three messages, one per profile. Short, specific, one ask.

MESSAGE 1 · PROGRAM OWNER · EMAIL

# COMPELLING CONTENT.

SUBJECT

**Repeat your best session, without re-planning it**

Hi [first name],

I run Algo Peers in Cape Coast. For five years we have taught hands-on computing to 1,000+ children, and the hardest part was always the same: a great session depends on one great facilitator.

We are now building Next Billion Children: ready-to-run Learning Worlds with materials, a facilitator guide and a shared AI helper, plus a short summary of what each child could do.

Would you be open to a 20-minute call next week to see if a pilot fits [program name]?

Sam Quansah · Founder, Algo Peers · samquansah@gse.harvard.edu

1. Subject names their outcome, not our product
2. Credibility in one line: five years, 1,000+ children
3. Names their pain before our solution
4. One small ask with a time box

MESSAGE 2 · SCHOOL LEADER · LINKEDIN

# COMPELLING CONTENT.

SUBJECT

**Your micro:bits, working every week**

Hi [first name], many schools we work with have computing kits that sit unused because lessons take hours to prepare.

NBC turns kits like micro:bits into ready-to-teach Learning Worlds, with a short record of what each pupil demonstrated, for parents and inspectors.

We are opening a few pilot classrooms this term. Could I send you a one-page outline?

Sam, Algo Peers

1. Opens with a problem they see daily
2. Uses equipment they already own
3. Evidence framed for their audience: parents
4. Low-commitment ask: a one-page outline

MESSAGE 3 · SPONSOR · EMAIL

# COMPELLING CONTENT.

SUBJECT

**Hands-on learning you can report on**

Dear [first name],

Algo Peers has worked with 31 public schools and 11,000+ learners in Cape Coast. Most of their children never get to build and test real things.

NBC delivers hands-on Learning Worlds in public schools, funded by sponsors, with a clear summary of what children demonstrated, and no children's data ever sold or shared.

Could we share a short sponsorship brief and find 20 minutes to talk?

Sam Quansah · Founder, Algo Peers

1. Scale and access up front
2. The gap their CSR goals target
3. Reportable outcome plus a data promise
4. Brief first, then a short call

SEQUENCE

# FOUR TOUCHES. FOURTEEN DAYS.

## DAY 0

EMAIL OR LINKEDIN

The core message

## DAY 3

SAME CHANNEL

A one-line nudge with a new detail: a 30-second clip of Farm World

## DAY 7

OTHER CHANNEL

Connect on LinkedIn, or email if we started there; offer the one-page brief

## DAY 14

EMAIL

A polite close: "Shall I close the loop?" Opt-out honoured

A reply at any step stops the sequence and moves the lead to "conversation". WhatsApp only after someone gives us their number. Sends go out Tuesday to Thursday mornings, local time.

05

# THE RESULTS

What we sent, who answered, and what we learned.

MESSAGES SENT

0 OF 25 SENT · STARTS WED 14 OCT

# 25 MESSAGES. SENT BY US, ONE BY ONE.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
| 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 |
| 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 |
| 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 |

- Each tile becomes a screenshot of a real sent message.
- Split: 10 program owners, 8 school leaders, 7 sponsors.
- Names and addresses blurred before publishing.

RESPONSES

# EVERY ANSWER COUNTS.

COLLECTED DURING TACTIC WEEK · REAL DATA ONLY

## POSITIVE

Wants a call or the brief

## REFERRAL

Points us to someone else

## NOT NOW

Interested, wrong timing

## NO

Declines or opts out

Real replies are added as annotated screenshots, with names blurred. Counts stay blank until replies arrive: we never estimate results.

RESULTS

COLLECTED DURING TACTIC WEEK · REAL DATA ONLY

# RESULTS BY PROFILE.

| PROFILE | LEADS | SENT | REPLIES | REPLY RATE | CALLS BOOKED | PILOT OFFERS | PASS LINE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Program owners** | — | — | — | — | — | — | 15% REPLY |
| **School leaders** | — | — | — | — | — | — | 10% REPLY |
| **Sponsors** | — | — | — | — | — | — | 8% REPLY |
| **Total** | — | — | — | — | — | — | 10 CALLS · 3 OFFERS |

Filled from the CRM on Tue 20 Oct. If a profile misses its pass line, we rewrite that message, not the target.

06

# THE PLAYBOOK

How we ran it, and how it compounds.

TACTICAL PLAYBOOK · STEPS

# TEN STEPS.

1. Set goals and pass lines before sending anything.
2. Chose three profiles from our persona work: program owners, school leaders, sponsors.
3. Mapped the watering holes for each profile, global first, then local.
4. Built a lead-list template and sourcing rules; started 50+ leads per profile.
5. Wrote one message per profile, annotated for problem, proof and ask.
6. Designed a four-touch, fourteen-day sequence across email and LinkedIn.
7. Set up CRM stages: sent, replied, call, pilot offer.
8. Send 25 first messages, then review and revise the weakest message.
9. Log every reply; book calls; record pilot offers.
10. Compare profiles against pass lines and choose who to focus on next.

# WHY IT MATTERS.

## HOW IT RELATES TO EARLIER TACTICS

Market research named the buyer; visual assets gave us a brand people trust; persona ads tested who responds. Outbound now turns those personas into named conversations.

## HOW IT RELATES TO OUR BUSINESS

Our first revenue is a program or site fee from operators and schools, and sponsored access from partners. Each needs a direct conversation.

## HOW WE WILL USE IT AGAIN

The same lists, messages and sequence work for each new city and country. Only the names and the local proof change.

## HOW IT ADVANCES THE BUSINESS

Calls become pilot offers; pilot offers test price and renewal, our biggest uncertainty, and give us evidence for the pre-seed raise.

07

# MEANWHILE

What else moved this week.

VENTURE UPDATE · PRODUCT

BUILT

# WEBSITE LIVE. PROTOTYPES NEXT.

- Our website is built and live.
- Three Learning Worlds (Farm, Ramp, Plant), a task format and classroom prototypes are at prototype stage.
- Positioned as Physical AI: physical learning, evidence and shared AI in one learning infrastructure.

VENTURE UPDATE · HARVARD

IN PROGRESS

# APPLYING TO VIP.

- Applying to the Harvard Innovation Labs Venture Incubation Program, as an i-lab member at Propel stage.
- Application built around our three riskiest assumptions: price, facilitator handover and transfer.

VENTURE UPDATE · FUNDING

PREPARING

# RAISING DIRECTLY.

- Preparing a pre-seed round to fund pilots, IP protection and two hires.
- Declined a paid capital-raising service: we raise directly through our network and i-lab.

NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

# LEARNING INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE NEXT BILLION CHILDREN.


TALK TO US

**Sam Quansah**

Founder · Mandela Washington Fellow

samquansah@gse.harvard.edu

samquans@mit.edu


THIS TACTIC

Outreach kit

Lead-list template

Full brand guide (PDF)

